

BIOTECHNOLOGY

2026 & 2027 OFFICIAL RATING FORM

MIDDLE SCHOOL

Judges: Using minimal (1-4 points), adequate (5-8 points), or exemplary (9-10 points) performance levels as a guideline in the rating form, record the scores earned for the event criteria in the column spaces to the right. The X1 or X2 notation in the criteria column is a multiplier factor for determining the points earned. (Example: an "adequate" score of 7 for an X1 criterion = 7 points; an "adequate" score of 7 for an X2 criterion = 14 points.) A score of zero (0) is acceptable if the minimal performance for any criterion is not met.

Go/No Go Specifications

- Before judging the entry, ensure that the items below are present; indicate presence with a check mark in the box.
- If an item is missing, leave the box next to the item blank and place a check mark in the box labeled ENTRY NOT EVALUATED.
- If a check mark is placed in the ENTRY NOT EVALUATED box, the entry is not to be judged.

- ☐ TIER 1 – Display is present
- ☐ TIER 2 – Documentation portfolio is present
- ☐ ENTRY NOT EVALUATED

TIER 1 – DISPLAY (90 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Definition and Explanation of the Issue and Solution (X1)	Unclear definition and explanation of the issue is evident; it is difficult to understand the solution being communicated; an illogical explanation is presented.	Issue is defined and explained adequately; the solution is acceptable.	There is evidence of a clear and concise definition and explanation of the issue; explanation is presented and communicated in an organized and concise manner.	
Explanation of Impacts (X2)	Explanation is missing a discussion of the issue's relevance to environmental, economic, social, and/or ethical considerations.	Explanation addresses some of the issue's relevance to environmental, economic, social, and/or ethical considerations.	Explanation includes a full discussion of the issue's relevance to environmental, economic, social, and/or ethical considerations.	
Supporting Information (X1)	Supporting information does not help to clarify documentation and/or it is of little significance to the issue.	Supporting information is appropriate and helps supplement the documentation by providing clarity to the issue.	Supporting information is highly effective and of excellent quality.	
Research, References, and Resources (X1)	Documentation lacks adequate research base, and/or very few credible sources are referenced.	Research is generally appropriate, with adequate credible sources.	A comprehensive research base that includes credible sources is evident.	
Communication of Issue (X1)	It is difficult to understand the issue being communicated; an illogical explanation is presented.	The issue is communicated and thoughts are somewhat organized.	The issue is communicated in an organized, clear, and concise manner.	
Communication of Solution (X1)	It is difficult to understand the solution being communicated; an illogical explanation is presented.	The solution is communicated and thoughts are somewhat organized.	The solution is communicated in an organized, clear, and concise manner.	
Creativity (X1)	The display lacks creativity; no, or very few, design principles are integrated in the display.	Some elements of creativity exist in the display, and essential design principles are generally evident.	The display exudes creativity; essential design principles and elements are well integrated.	
Aesthetics and Artanship (X1)	Display is unorganized and sloppy; display seems to be an afterthought or thrown together.	Display is somewhat organized and aesthetically pleasing.	Display is logical, organized, cohesive, and aesthetically pleasing.	
TIER 1 – DISPLAY SUBTOTAL (90 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.

Indicate the rule violated: _____

TIER 1 – SUBTOTAL (90 points)

TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO (60 points)

CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	Record scores in the column spaces below.
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Portfolio Components (X1)	Portfolio is unorganized and/or is missing three (3) or more components.	Portfolio is missing one (1) or two (2) components and/or is loosely organized.	Portfolio has all required components in order and is well organized.	
Definition and Explanation of Issue (X1)	Definition and explanation of the issue is unclear.	Issue is generally defined and explained, but some points could use additional clarification.	Clear and concise definition and explanation of the issue is evident.	
Research Base (X1)	Research is inadequate, and/or very few credible sources are referenced.	Research has been conducted appropriately, with some credible sources included.	Research indicates evidence of a comprehensive assortment of materials that are credible sources.	
Support Materials (X1)	Support materials do not help clarify the documentation and/or are of very little significance to the issue.	Support materials are somewhat appropriate and lend some clarity to the issue.	Support materials are of excellent quality; if not original, they are cited; support materials clarify the issue.	
Work Log (X1)	Log is poorly organized and/or incomplete.	Log is adequately detailed and organized and contains most of the required components.	Log is well documented and contains all the required components.	
Quality and Effectiveness (X1)	Portfolio appears to have been thrown together; distracting errors in punctuation, grammar, and spelling are evident in the documentation.	Portfolio is generally organized; punctuation, grammar, and spelling are correct for the most part, with few errors.	Work is of exceptional quality and well organized; punctuation, grammar, and spelling are correct, with no errors.	
TIER 2 – DOCUMENTATION PORTFOLIO SUBTOTAL (60 points)				

Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right.

Indicate the rule violated: _____

PRELIMINARY SUBTOTAL (150 points)

SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW (60 points)				Record scores in the column spaces below.
CRITERIA	Minimal performance	Adequate performance	Exemplary performance	
	1-4 points	5-8 points	9-10 points	
Organization (X1)	Participants seem unorganized and unprepared for the presentation, with an illogical explanation of the problem and solution.	Participants are generally prepared for the presentation; explanation of the problem and solution are somewhat communicated and organized.	The presentation is logical, well-organized, and easy to follow; the problem and solution are communicated in an organized and concise manner.	
Articulation (X1)	Communication of the solution is unclear, unorganized, and/or illogical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are not evident.	Communication of the solution is somewhat logical and clear; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are somewhat evident.	Communication of the solution is clear, concise, and logical; leadership and/or 21 st century skills are clearly evident.	
Delivery (X1)	The team is verbose and/or uncertain in its presentation/interview; participants' posture, gestures, and lack of eye contact diminish the delivery; little to no references are made to the display and/or documentation portfolio.	The team is generally well-spoken and clear in its presentation/interview; participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact are acceptable in the delivery; some references are made to the display and/or documentation portfolio.	The team is well-spoken and distinct in its presentation/interview; participants' posture, gestures, and eye contact result in a polished, natural, and effective delivery; multiple appropriate and effective references are made to the display and/or documentation portfolio to enhance the delivery.	
Knowledge (X2)	Participants seem to have little understanding of the concepts in their project; answers to questions may be vague.	Participants exhibit an understanding of the concepts in their project.	Participants show clear evidence of a thorough understanding of the project	
Team Participation (X1)	Majority of the presentation/interview is made by one member of the team; the other team members may be disengaged.	Team members generally are engaged in the process, though one member may take on more responsibility than the other(s).	All team members are actively involved in the presentation/interview.	
SEMIFINAL PRESENTATION/INTERVIEW SUBTOTAL (60 points)				
Rules violations (a deduction of 20% of the total possible points for the above sections) must be initialed by the judge, coordinator, and manager of the event. Record the deduction in the space to the right. Indicate the rule violated: _____				
TIME DEDUCTIONS				
A five-(5) point deduction will be incurred for any time infraction.				
SEMIFINAL SUBTOTAL (60 points)				
To arrive at the TOTAL score, add any subtotals and subtract rules violation points, as necessary. TOTAL (210 points)				

Comments:

I certify these results to be true and accurate to the best of my knowledge.

JUDGE

Printed name: _____ Signature: _____